Envir Sc 1C03 - Environmental Issues Infographic Assignment

Worth: Total: 10% of your final mark

Date Assigned: Week of January 5, 2026
Draft Infographic Due: Lab period, week of February 23
Final Version Due: March 5, 11:30 p.m. EST

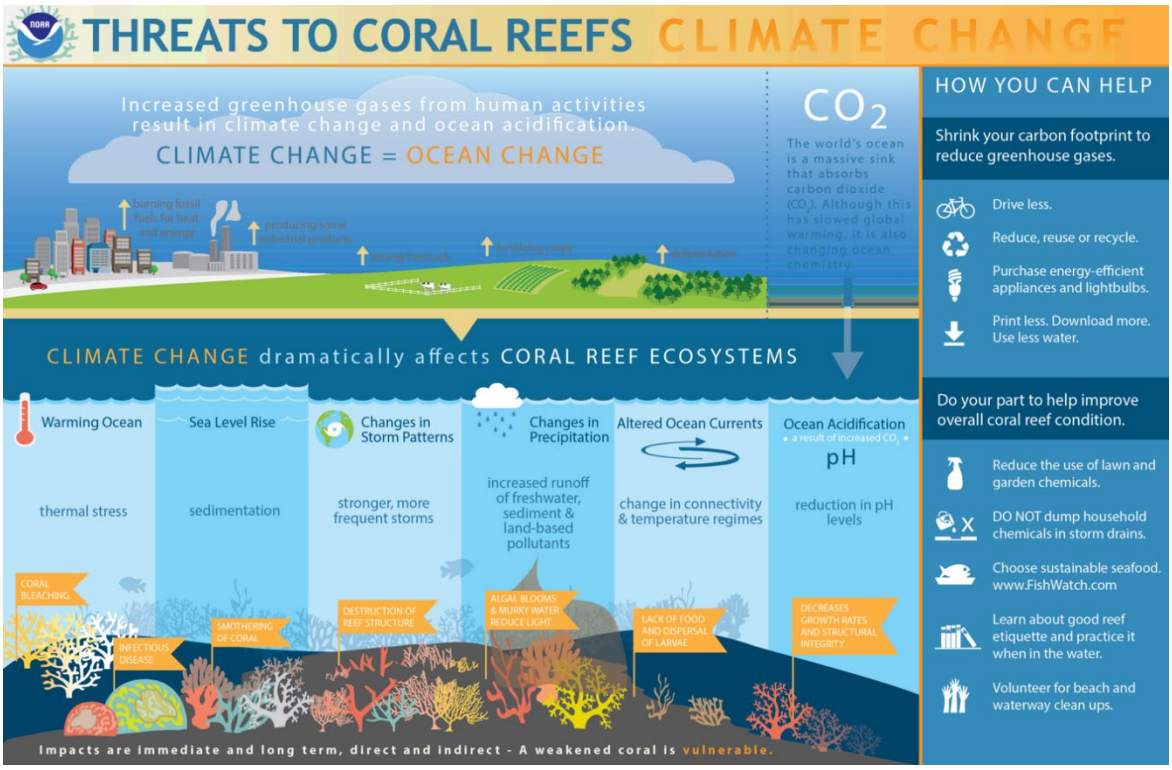
Please note: The Academic Integrity Quiz must be completed prior to submitting the Final version of the Infographic.

You are responsible for submitting the deliverable(s) in the appropriate folder on Avenue to Learn. No accommodation will be made for having submitted a deliverable in the wrong folder.

What is an infographic?

An **infographic** is a visually captivating image that depicts data or information in a way that makes the topic easy to understand and captivates the audience. Depicted below is an infographic on the impact of Climate Change on Coral Reefs by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

© Luc Bernier [2026]



Assignment

In this assignment, you will research one of the environmental issues listed below and create an Infographic of your findings. The purpose of this assignment is to increase your understanding of an environmental issue, to build research skills, and to present your research in a visually captivating format.

This assignment will be done in two parts: a draft infographic (evaluated by a peer during your lab period), and your final version which will be assessed by your Teaching Assistant.

Topics

You must choose **one** of the environmental issues listed below. You can narrow down the scope of the topic if it still covers the main environmental issue. For example, if the chosen topic is 'Plastics in the Oceans' you may choose to focus on one city, one state/province or one country.

This term's topics are as follows:

© Luc Bernier [2026]

- Environmental Impacts of Fast Fashion
- Desertification
- Coral bleaching
- Environmental impacts of food waste
- Urban Heat islands

Infographic resources

You will be using free online tools to create an Infographic on your chosen topic. Make sure you choose a resource that will allow you to save your Infographic as you develop it, and that allows you to download the final product in a good resolution and appropriate format for submission (for example, as a .pdf).

Please note: If you use a website, it is your responsibility to set up and manage your own account and passwords. As these are external websites to McMaster, we cannot assist with any issues related to lost account access, passwords, or issues with the individual websites. If you are having trouble with a particular platform, please try another platform.

Required Elements and Referencing

You must include the following elements in your Infographic:

- **Title** - the infographic must contain a clear and relevant title

- **Topic Statement** – an introduction to the topic as well as a clear statement addressing the environmental issue

- **Visuals**– supporting information on the environmental issue and a presentation of your research. All information must be referenced. Your Infographic must also include at least:
  - 1 geographic map. More information here about what is a geographic map: Geospatial Literacy Modules.
  - 1 graph, chart, or table (e.g.: line graph, bar graph, data table, pie chart), i.e., a graphical representation of data.
  - Note: The above items cannot come from lecture notes or e-learning modules

© Luc Bernier [2026]

- **Text –** There must be text supporting the visuals in your Infographic. There is no word limit on the text, *but* your entire Infographic should present well, and text should be legible when printed on standard or legal-size paper (8.5” x 11” or 8.5” x 14”). **Information must be presented in your own words** (i.e.: paraphrased) and must be cited appropriately (footnotes are acceptable). Information included in the infographic must be relevant to the topic, be scientifically accurate and use appropriate/scientific terminology.

- **Solutions/How you can Help** – the infographic must include solutions to or ways to mitigate the environmental problem

- **References –** a list of references used in your research. All information within your Infographic must be referenced, including the text and graphics/pictures/etc. (i.e., in-text citations or footnotes). You must also include a reference list on your infographic (usually depicted at the bottom of the infographic). A URL shortener can be used to reduce the amount of space taken by the list of references, but make sure that the link created is stable (i.e.: it always brings the reader to your intended source). If you only provide shortened URLs in your reference list on your infographic, please be sure to include a full citation list as a separate .docx file when submitting your assignment. For the text portion of your infographic, **you must use at least 5 reputable sources of information**. Lecture notes and e- Learning modules do not count as sources of information.

- **Size** – must fit on 8.5” x 11” or 8.5” x 14” paper. Text must be legible and graphics of good quality when printed at this size.

- **Note:** Remember, your Infographics are visual representations of scientific data. There should be a good balance of text and visuals in your final product (see the Infographic included at the start of these guidelines).

Refer to the “Assignment Evaluation” section at the end for additional expectations)

Referencing

- You must fully reference within the text all information presented using the author, date using the Harvard referencing system.
- More information about Harvard Referencing here:

© Luc Bernier [2026]

https://libguides.ucd.ie/harvardstyle/

Part A: Infographic Draft and Peer-Review Session

2% of grade in the course

In lab the week of February 23, you must bring a copy of your infographic to show your peers during the peer-review session. You can either bring a copy of your infographic on your personal device, or a printed draft of your Infographic. A printed draft should be printed on one 8.5" x11" or 8.5" x 14" paper (*printing in black and white is acceptable for the draft*).

Your Infographic will be peer-reviewed during the lab period: you will have your Infographic Draft evaluated by a peer, while you will evaluate your peer's work. The review grid will be nearly identical to the Rubric that will be used by your Teaching Assistant to assess your final version (see below).

Infographic Draft Review

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Failure to Meet Criterion
Content (16)			
Infographic contains a clear and relevant **Title**	2 (Yes, contains a relevant title)	1 (Contains a title, but some improvements needed)	0 (Does not contain a title)
Infographic includes a **Topic Statement** that introduces the reader to the topic and what the environmental issue is	2 (Yes, contains a clear topic statement)	1 (Contains a topic statement, but some improvements needed)	0 (Does not contain a topic statement)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Knowledge - level of understanding and knowledge of the topic demonstrated	2 (Demonstrates an excellent level of understanding of the topic)	1 (Demonstrates a good level of understanding of the topic)	0 (Does not demonstrate a good level of understanding of the topic)
Relevance of Information - Information presented in the infographic is relevant to the topic	2 (All information presented is relevant to the topic)	1 (Most information presented is relevant to the topic; some improvements needed)	0 (Most Information is not relevant to the topic)
Solutions/How you can Help – the infographic includes solutions to or ways to mitigate the environmental problem	2 (Includes good solutions/ strategies to mitigate the environmental problem)	1 (Solutions presented need some improvement)	0 (Does not contain solutions/ mitigation strategies)
Infographic uses precise/appropriate scientific **Terminology**	2 (Infographic uses precise/appropriate scientific terminology)	1 (Some improvements needed to terminology used)	0 (Does not use precise/ appropriate scientific terminology)
Information presented is **Scientifically Accuracy**	2 (All information presented is scientifically accurate)	1 (Some improvements needed in scientific accuracy)	0 (Information is not scientifically accurate)
Spelling and Grammar	2 (No mistake)	1 (One mistake)	0 (2 mistakes)

Criteria	**Excellent**	**Good**	**Failure to Meet Criterion**
Visuals (10 marks)			

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Infographic contains a **relevant Map**	2 (yes, contains a relevant map)	1 (contains a map, but relevance not clear)	0 (no, does not contain a map)
Infographic contains **1 relevant chart, graph, or table**	2 (yes, contains 1 relevant chart, graph or table)	1 (Contains a chart, graph or table, but relevance not clear)	0 (no, does not contain a chart, graph or table)
Figure Descriptions - Data on graphs/map/chart clearly described nearby so reader understands	2 (Figures are well-described)	1 (Figure descriptions are not clear or incomplete)	0 (There are no figure descriptions)
Resolution of Visuals	2 (Visuals are High resolution)	1 (Visuals are Medium or Low resolution)	0 (No visuals present)
Text to Image Ratio – Infographic is mostly data presented in a visual format, has a good balance of visuals (major) and text (minor).	2 (Data presented as visuals are major component, text is kept to a minimum)	1 (too much text, visuals minimal)	0 (either all text or all visuals)
Colour Scheme, Aesthetics and Flow (8 marks)			
Colour Scheme is consistent throughout the infographic	2 (consistent colour scheme)	1 (mostly consistent scheme, some improvements needed)	0 (inconsistent colour scheme)
Aesthetics – infographic commands the attention of the reader/is eye-catching	2 (eye-catching and aesthetically pleasing)	1 (somewhat eye-catching and aesthetically pleasing)	0 (not aesthetically pleasing)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Infographic Text is easy to read (ie. Good size, easy to read font style and colour)	2 (easy to read)	1 (some improvements needed)	0 (difficult to read)
Organization/Flow - Logical flow of ideas/organization (ie. Reads left-right or top to bottom)	2 (logical flow)	1 (mostly logical, some improvements needed)	0 (Flow is not logical)
References (6 marks)			
In-text citations or Footnotes are present within the text, data, and figures presented in the infographic	2 (all data and images are referenced)	1 (some data/images are referenced)	0 (no information is referenced)
Reference list is provided **<u>on the infographic</u>** itself (usually located on the bottom)	2 (full reference list on infographic)	1 (partial reference list on infographic)	0 (no reference list)
Reference list has at least 5 references from **reputable sources**	2 (at least 5 reputable)	1 (1-4 reputable sources)	0 (no reputable)

Infographic Draft Evaluation
(2 marks total)

While the score you will obtain from you peer will be purely informative and carry no weight, you will also be formally evaluated by your Teaching Assistant for:

- The completeness and quality of your draft (**1 mark**)
- The quality of the evaluation of your peer's work (**1 mark**)

Completion of an Infographic Draft	1 Full Draft	0.5 Partial Draft	0 No Draft
Completion of an Infographic Peer Review	1 Full Review	0.5 Partial Review	0 No review

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Part B: Final Assignment Submission

(8% of the grade in the course)

You will submit the final version of your assignment to the Assignment box on Avenue:

i. **Submission of Infographic to Avenue Assignment box:** You must submit your infographic to the Assignment box on Avenue to Learn. Avenue dropbox accepts the following formats: html, doc, docx, hwp, odt, rtf, wpd, txt, ps, pdf, pptx, ppt, ppsx, pps, xls, xlsx, gdoc. **PDF is preferred.**

ii. **Submission of Text to Avenue Assignment box:** You must submit a **.docx** file of any text in your infographic to the Assignment box on Avenue.

Submissions to Avenue will be evaluated for plagiarism using Turnitin.com. A Similarity Report will be generated, which evaluates the similarity of your work to billions of documents on the internet and other submitted works in the Turnitin repository. Plagiarism will not be tolerated. **Any Similarity Report above 10% will be investigated**.

PLEASE NOTE: If your sources/reference list are being highlighted in your Infographic Text .docx file in Turnitin (<u>not applicable to your infographic visual</u>), resulting in a higher similarity score, please remove your sources from your text document and <u>submit your sources as a separate, third document.</u>

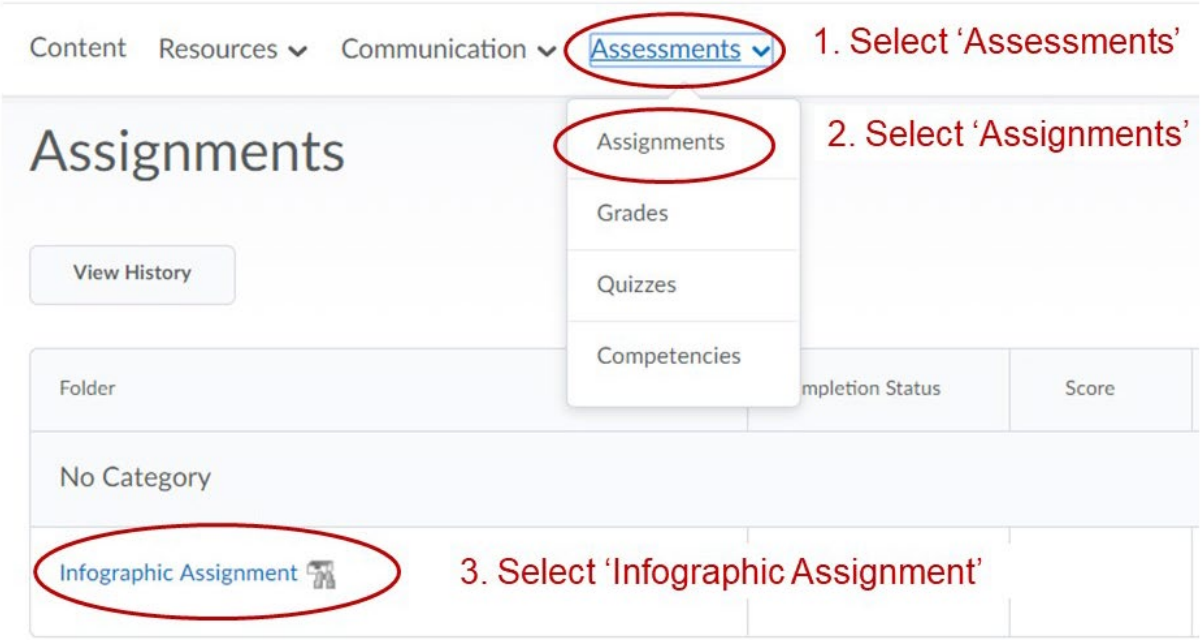
This will mean you will submit the following:

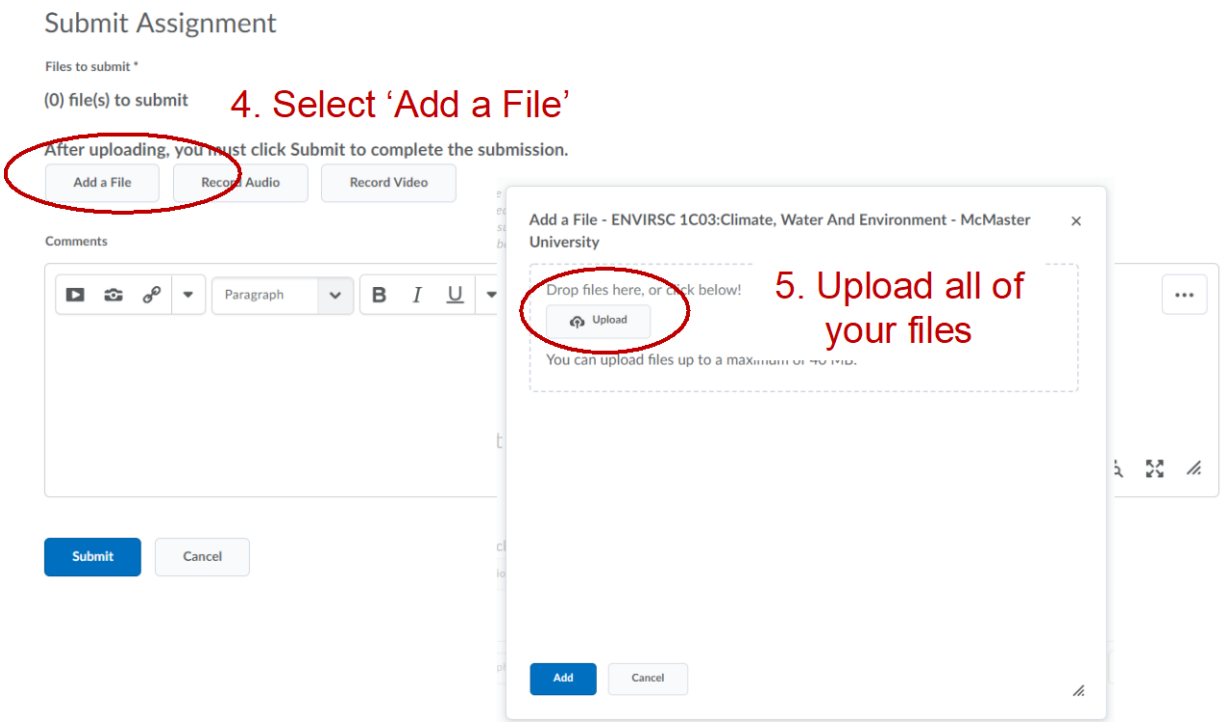
- 1) Infographic Visual with sources (see acceptable formats above)
- 2) Infographic text (without sources) as a .docx
- 3) Reference List as a .docx

Everything must be submitted on Avenue **by March 5, 11:30 PM EST**.

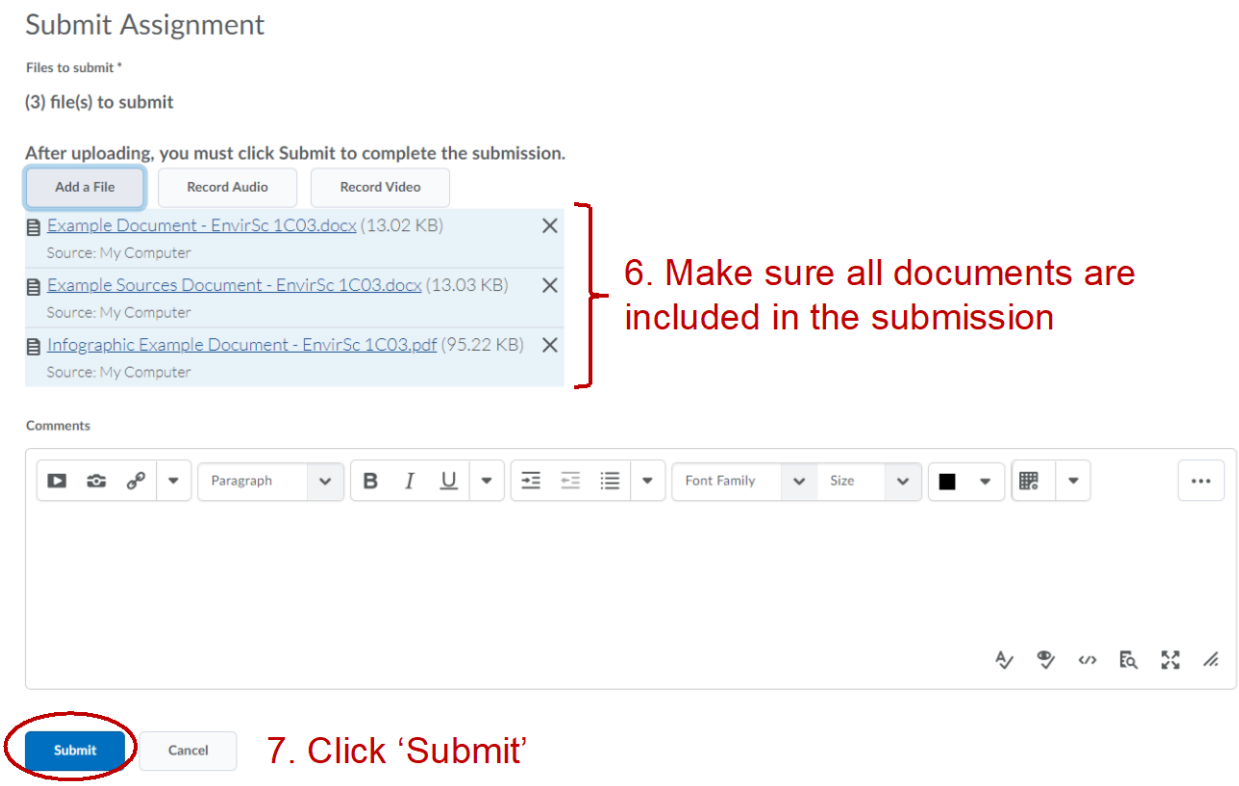
Avenue Assignment box Submission Guide

© Luc Bernier [2026]





© Luc Bernier [2026]



Assignment Evaluation
(44 marks total)

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Failure to Meet Criterion
Content (16)			
Infographic contains a clear and relevant **Title**	2 (Yes, contains a relevant title)	1 (Contains a title, but some improvements needed)	0 (Does not contain a title)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Infographic includes a **Topic Statement** that introduces the reader to the topic and what the environmental issue is	2 (Yes, contains a clear topic statement)	1 (Contains a topic statement, but some improvements needed)	0 (Does not contain a topic statement)
Knowledge - level of understanding and knowledge of the topic demonstrated	2 (Demonstrates an excellent level of understanding of the topic)	1 (Demonstrates a good level of understanding of the topic)	0 (Does not demonstrate a good level of understanding of the topic)
Relevance of Information - Information presented in the infographic is relevant to the topic	2 (All information presented is relevant to the topic)	1 (Most information presented is relevant to the topic; some improvements needed)	0 (Most Information is not relevant to the topic)
Solutions/How you can Help – the infographic includes solutions to or ways to mitigate the environmental problem	2 (Includes good solutions/ strategies to mitigate the environmental problem)	1 (Solutions presented need some improvement)	0 (Does not contain solutions/ mitigation strategies)
Infographic uses precise/appropriate scientific **Terminology**	2 (Infographic uses precise/appropria te scientific terminology)	1 (Some improvements needed to terminology used)	0 (Does not use precise/ appropriate scientific terminology)
Information presented is **Scientifically Accuracy**	2 (All information presented is scientifically accurate)	1 (Some improvements needed in scientific accuracy)	0 (Information is not scientifically accurate)
Spelling and Grammar	2 (No mistake)	1 (One mistake)	0 (2 mistakes)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Failure to Meet Criterion
Visuals (10 marks)			
Infographic contains a **relevant Map**	2 (yes, contains a relevant map)	1 (contains a map, but relevance not clear)	0 (no, does not contain a map)
Infographic contains **1 relevant chart, graph, or table**	2 (yes, contains 1 relevant chart, graph or table)	1 (Contains a chart, graph or table, but relevance not clear)	0 (no, does not contain a chart, graph or table)
Figure Descriptions - Data on graphs/map/chart clearly described nearby so reader understands	2 (Figures are well-described)	1 (Figure descriptions are not clear or incomplete)	0 (There are no figure descriptions)
Resolution of Visuals	2 (Visuals are High resolution)	1 (Visuals are Medium or Low resolution)	0 (No visuals present)
Text to Image Ratio – Infographic is mostly data presented in a visual format, has a good balance of visuals (major) and text (minor).	2 (Data presented as visuals are major component, text is kept to a minimum)	1 (too much text, visuals minimal)	0 (either all text or all visuals)
Colour Scheme, Aesthetics and Flow (8 marks)			
Colour Scheme is consistent throughout the infographic	2 (consistent colour scheme)	1 (mostly consistent scheme, some improvements needed)	0 (inconsistent colour scheme)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

Aesthetics – infographic commands the attention of the reader/is eye-catching	2 (eye-catching and aesthetically pleasing)	1 (somewhat eye-catching and aesthetically pleasing)	0 (not aesthetically pleasing)
Infographic Text is easy to read (ie. Good size, easy to read font style and colour)	2 (easy to read)	1 (some improvements needed)	0 (difficult to read)
Organization/Flow - Logical flow of ideas/organization (ie. Reads left-right or top to bottom)	2 (logical flow)	1 (mostly logical, some improvements needed)	0 (Flow is not logical)
References (6 marks)			
In-text citations or Footnotes are present within the text, data, and figures presented in the infographic	2 (all data and images are referenced)	1 (some data/images are referenced)	0 (no information is referenced)
Reference list is provided **<u>on the infographic</u>** itself (usually located on the bottom)	2 (full reference list on infographic)	1 (partial reference list on infographic)	0 (no reference list)
Reference list has at least 5 references from **reputable sources**	2 (at least 5 reputable)	1 (1-4 reputable sources)	0 (no reputable)
Submission Format (4 marks)			
Separate text document included for Turnitin similarity check	2 (full document included)	1 (document included, but does not match infographic)	0 (no document included)
Infographic is an appropriate size and would print well on either an 8.5” x 11” or 8.5” x 14” piece of paper.	2 (appropriate size)	1 (appropriate size, but text/images would not be legible if printed)	0 (too large; larger than 8.5” x 14”)

© Luc Bernier [2026]

© Luc Bernier [2026]

COPYRIGHT NOTICE

© Luc Bernier [2026]

This work the intellectual property of the instructor (unless otherwise noted), and are protected by law under Canada's *Copyright Act*. Unless a users' right in the *Copyright Act* covers the particular use, students must not publish, post on a public Internet site, sell, rent, or otherwise distribute this work without the instructor's express permission. If you have questions about fair dealing and your other rights to use works for educational purposes, please contact **copyright@mcmaster.ca**

© Luc Bernier [2026]